

Numbers, dates, and time

NUMBERS ARE REPRESENTED IN WRITING AS BOTH NUMERALS AND WORDS.

In addition to mathematical calculations, numerals are sometimes used in writing. They are especially useful for writing dates and time, and decimals and numbers over one hundred.

SEE ALSO

◀ 94–95 Periods and ellipses

◀ 96–99 Commas

◀ 102–103 Colons

◀ 106–107 Hyphens

◀ 114–115 Parentheses and dashes

Abbreviations

172–173 ▶



- When writing a **range of numerals**, as in page references, write the first and last page of the reference and **separate the numerals** with a dash: for example, 14–17 (which includes pages 15 and 16).
- When writing informally, **years can be abbreviated** using an apostrophe followed by the last two numerals, as in “the summer of ’97.”

Writing out numbers

Fractions and numbers up to one hundred should be written out as words, unless the text uses numbers frequently, as in scientific or mathematical works.

eight spaceships

The numeral 8 is written out.

The **Arabic numbering system** is more accurate than the **Roman system** because it includes the **number zero**.

GLOSSARY

Arabic numerals Everyday numerals such as 1, 2, and 3.

Roman numerals Numbers represented by certain letters of the alphabet, such as *i*, *v*, and *x*.

Flying on board **eight** spaceships, discovered **325** comets on **April 10**,

Arabic numerals

Everyday numerals are called Arabic numerals because Arabs introduced them to Europe from India. The ten characters are 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, and 9. These are combined to represent every possible number.

325 comets

Use Arabic numerals for numbers over one hundred.

Dates

Numerals are always used for the day and year of a date. When writing years of more than four digits, as in 10,000 BCE, a comma is used. If the month comes first, a comma is needed between the date and year, and after the year when the date appears in the middle of the sentence.

Date format

Example

day-month-year

The discovery on 10 April 2099 was exciting.

month-day-year

The discovery on April 10, 2099, was exciting.

year-month-day

The discovery on 2099 April 10 was exciting.